Instructions: Copy this form it and submit to the basic participation assignment that is tied to the course staff member you believe is going to recognize you best from Discussion Section or Office Hours. **Don't mess with the pagination or it will not be properly recognized.**

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[On this page, you should only insert your current picture here so we can easily match your name to a person]



Who do you consider the course staff member who is most capable of recognizing your participation? Please check the Course Website https://berkeley-cs182.github.io/fa25/staff/ for the list and photos of all staff.

- ☐ **Sultan Daniels**
- ☐ **Patrick Mendoza**
- ☐ **Alex Proshkin**
- ☐ **Lance Mathias**
- ☑ ~~**Joey Hong**~~
- ☐ **Kevin Frans**
- ☐ **Prof. Gireeja Ranade**
- ☐ **Prof. Anant Sahai**
- ☐ **Nobody**

Are there other members of course staff with whom you've interacted frequently? Your primary staff member may consult them for help in assigning your grade.

- ☑ ~~**Sultan Daniels**~~
- ☐ **Patrick Mendoza**
- ☐ **Alex Proshkin**
- ☐ **Lance Mathias**
- ☑ ~~**Joey Hong**~~
- ☐ **Kevin Frans**
- ☑ ~~**Prof. Gireeja Ranade**~~
- ☑ ~~**Prof. Anant Sahai**~~
- ☐ **Nobody**

Are you claiming basic participation credit on the basis of in-person regular attendance?

- ☑ ~~**Yes! I attended the vast majority of discussions and participated actively with the students around me.**~~
- ☐ **Sort-of. I attended about half of the discussions and want partial basic credit via attendance.**
- ☐ **A little. I came to 3-4 discussions only and want some basic credit for this.**
- ☐ **No.**

Are you claiming basic participation on the basis of online participation on EdStem? If so, include screenshots below of your most notable follow-ups/posts along with the number of the parent post. (e.g. #297 is the EdStem post for Lectures 21 and 22) Use up to two pages for these.

[Second page of screenshots]

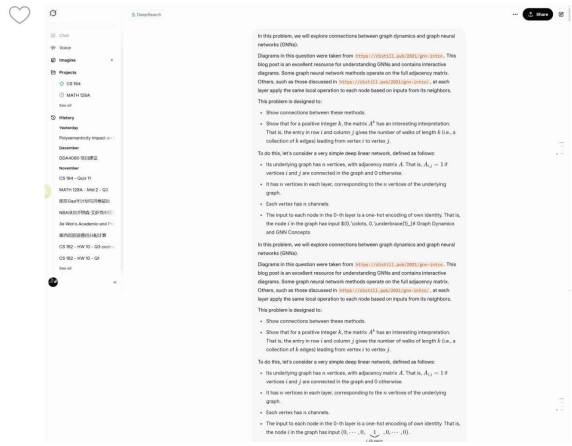
Special Participation Credit. (Recall that you are required to do 4 of these for full credit. Pro-rated up to that.) Check the ones that you did and add the number of your post. Include a screenshot below it to remind us. ***Please verify that you have also submitted to gradescope so we have you recorded there for automated grading scripts to detect your submissions. If you haven't please do so now.***

- ☑ ~~Special A: #~~
- ☑ ~~Special B: #~~
- ☐ Special C: #
- ☐ Special C: #
- ☑ ~~Special E: #~~
- ☑ ~~Special E: #~~
- ☐ Special D: Please replace this with all post numbers corresponding to this.

Special Participation A: Hw 6 with Grok #681

Menger Wen
3 hours ago in Curiosity

STAR WATCHING 5 VIEWS



Special Participation B: ChatGPT 5.1 Standard Thinking on HW7 #687

Menger Wen
2 hours ago in Curiosity

STAR WATCHING 5 VIEWS

For Special Participation B, I used ChatGPT 5.1 Standard Thinking on the coding portion of HW 7.

- Here is the link to my chat:
  - Q1
  - Q2
  - Q5: https://chatgpt.com/share/69363e3f-87f0-8006-a054-9b6d8eec7aa5, https://chatgpt.com/share/69363e56-3044-8006-b71f-72208ff5cc80

Formal Code Review (Best for a report or official feedback)

Assessment of ChatGPT 5.1 Standard Thinking Performance on HW7

Executive Summary: The model demonstrated high proficiency, successfully completing the RNN, Last-Name Classifier, and Autoencoder tasks in alignment with staff specifications. However, the Graph-Clustering module contains two significant mathematical errors regarding the adjacency and degree matrices that require correction to function correctly.

Detailed Findings:

- **Graph-Clustering (Spectral):** This section requires revision.
  - **Critical Defect:** The RBF kernel implementation incorrectly calculated similarity using $exp(+\gamma|x_i - x_j|^2)$. This must be corrected to a negative exponent $(-\gamma)$ to properly represent similarity.
  - **API Inconsistency:** The function `get_degree_matrix` returns the inverse-square-root $(D^{-1/2})$ rather than the standard Degree matrix (D). While the subsequent Laplacian calculation compensates for this, the naming convention violates the prompt requirements and risks confusion.

Special Participation E: DeepSeek as Web3 teacher #688

Menger Wen
2 hours ago in Curiosity

STAR WATCHING 5 VIEWS

For special participation part E, I asked DeepSeek to teach me how to write a smart contract on BTC chain: https://chat.deepseek.com/share/9wu5248zp1z8hls9xy

Based on our conversation, here is a summary in English of what I have accomplished and the current situation:

Progress Summary

I have successfully completed the initial setup and are very close to deploying my first Bitcoin smart contract. Here is what I have done:

- ✅ **Environment Setup**: I installed all prerequisite tools (`Node.js`, `NPM`, `Git`) on my Windows 11 computer.
- ✅ **Core Tools Installation**: I installed the global CLI tool (`@opcat-labs/cli-opcat`) which is used to create and manage projects.
- ✅ **Project Creation**: I created a new project named `helloworld` using the CLI. This command automatically generated the complete project structure and configuration files.
- ✅ **Project Dependencies (SDK)**: I entered the project directory and ran `npm install`. This installed all necessary dependencies for the project, including the crucial `@opcat-labs/scrypt-ts-opcat` **SDK**—the library containing the functions and classes needed to write my contract.
- ✅ **Smart Contract Code**: I correctly modified the main contract file (`src/contracts/helloworld.ts`), creating a simple contract that stores a hash and can only be unlocked by providing the matching message.
- ✅ **Contract Compilation**: I ran `npm run compile`, which successfully transformed my TypeScript code into a blockchain-readable format and generated a contract artifact file (`artifacts/contracts/helloworld.json`).
- ✅ **Test Key Generation**: I generated a private key for the Bitcoin testnet using `npm run genprivkey`. The command provided I with a testnet address

Special Participation E: DeepSeek as quantitative finance (factor investing) teacher #691

Menger Wen
2 hours ago in Curiosity

STAR WATCHING 2 VIEWS

For special participation part E, I asked DeepSeek to teach me how to improve a factor's performance in quantitative investing: https://chat.deepseek.com/share/hicc0bcs9s3x02hm5x

Summary of Achievements

Through our iterative collaboration, I have made significant progress in quantitative factor development and refinement. Here are the key achievements:

1. **In-Depth Problem Identification**
   - Successfully identified a specific performance anomaly: **abnormal returns in the tail portion (small factor values)** of my originally constructed factor.
   - Conducted systematic factor evaluation, pinpointing that the core issue lies in **factor construction logic** rather than superficial parameter tuning.
2. **Structured Analysis & Hypothesis Generation**
   - Developed a structured analysis framework to dissect the factor's underlying logic, identifying multiple potential root causes:
     - **Weight distortion in extreme markets** due to the `clip()` function
     - **Standardization failure in tail regions** during high volatility
     - **Signal misalignment** in price-volume divergence scenarios
     - **Multi-cycle signal conflict** in tail market conditions
3. **Systematic Improvement Methodology**
   - Implemented a **methodical testing approach** by developing independent, modular improvement